



PROGRESS REPORT

Eritrea: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-10-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-10.

Progress values. *Movement* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	No national digital transformation strategy is held. What the government has adopted is sectoral: a policy for technology in education and a geospatial framework action plan. The base holds two adopted policy instruments touching digital questions and no overarching one. The first is the policy for technology in education, which governs one sector. The second is the domesticated geospatial information framework action plan, which governs one class of data. Against that, the telecommunications union's own survey of national plans records the country as having no adopted broadband strategy. A country with a sector policy for schools, an action plan for maps and nothing for the network they both run on has no strategy in the sense this indicator asks about, and nothing on the base records one being drafted.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	The sector rests on a 1998 communications proclamation and its regulations; the only sectoral policy named is for education. The base holds no national digital or ICT strategy for this country. What it holds instead is the sector's legal furniture, listed in a country profile and not held as text: Communications Proclamation 102 of 1998, which set the legal basis for communications, the Regulations on Telecommunications Networks and Services issued as Legal Notice 43 of 1998, and a 2003 proclamation establishing the state telecommunications corporation. The one sector-specific policy named anywhere is a National Policy for ICT in Education setting goals for connectivity, ministry systems, staff training and school use of technology. The 2018-2022 National Education Sector Plan carries it forward, aiming at technology infrastructure and e-learning options, on the back of an ICT in education initiative the ministry launched in January 2005. The sector plan states its own result: incorporating technology in education remains difficult for want of facilities, equipment and teacher training. Neither the policy nor the plan is held as a document, and the profile carrying them is a legacy platform its publisher states is no longer updated.	NO CHANGE a first stated position with no earlier account behind it
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	The telecommunications union's own survey of national plans records the country as having none. Nothing later on the base records one being adopted. The absence is documented rather than merely unfound. The telecommunications union's survey of broadband strategies, policies and plans carries the country in its table with no plan against it; neighbouring entries in the same table carry theirs, so the reading is unambiguous. What governs the sector instead is the communications proclamation of 1998, which makes the ministry's communications department sole regulator and sets the development of national communications capability as an objective without setting a target for it. Nothing published since names a broadband target, a coverage obligation or a date.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy	No storage or cloud strategy is held. The nearest thing to a stated position is the state operator's own private cloud service, hosted in its own data centres. Nothing on the base states where government data should be held, on whose equipment, or under what terms. The one document that describes domestic hosting at all is a commercial one: the state operator's private cloud service page, which offers subscription storage hosted entirely in the operator's own facilities. That makes domestic hosting the practical default without anyone having chosen it as a policy. No public body's hosting arrangement is published, no procurement rule addresses it, and no residency or localisation instrument was located.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap	A national action plan to domesticate the UN geospatial information framework is the first interoperability roadmap on the base (action plan). Eritrea produced a national action plan in April 2026 to domesticate the United Nations Integrated Geospatial Information Framework, intended to improve the integration and interoperability of geospatial information and national data systems (action plan). The position it moves from is comprehensive absence: a 2022 structured assessment records no government enterprise architecture framework, no government interoperability framework, no data quality framework and no government service bus platform (dataset). The plan is geospatial in scope rather than whole-of-government, and the base holds no adoption date, budget or implementing body for it.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	The government scores zero on policy capacity in the 2025 artificial-intelligence readiness index, ranking 193rd (index). The government artificial-intelligence readiness index for 2025, updated in January 2026 across 195 governments, scores Eritrea zero on policy capacity and ranks it 193rd overall on 13.69 (index). The index awards a national strategy score only for a published strategy or a published draft, and Eritrea has neither. A June 2026 legal-status review records the same absence from the legal side: no national artificial-intelligence strategy (review). The base does hold one AI system in state hands — an agricultural expert system inside a ministry information system — so the absence is of policy, not of the technology.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies	No localisation or residency rule is held. Domestic hosting happens anyway, because the only provider-hosted cloud on the base is the state operator's own. No instrument states where public or personal data may be held. There is no hosting duty on public bodies, no rule on transfers out and no authority that could grant or refuse one, the data-protection law itself being absent. What produces localisation in practice is the shape of the market rather than a rule. The state operator's private cloud is hosted in its own data centres, and no foreign provider is recorded serving the country. Data stays where it is because there is nowhere else for it to go, which is not the same position as a country that has chosen it.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	The geospatial framework action plan is the first data-governance instrument on the base (action plan). The April 2026 action plan to domesticate the geospatial information framework covers governance arrangements for national geospatial data, the first instrument of its kind on the base (action plan). Against it, a 2022 structured assessment records no data quality framework and no system exchanging data across financial management, human resources, payroll, customs, tax or social insurance (dataset), and there is no data-protection law or authority (redetermination). A sectoral plan is not a national data-governance policy, and nothing on the base claims one exists.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy	No open data policy, portal or licence is held. Government data reaches the public as survey reports, not as datasets. Nothing on the base names an open data policy, a dataset catalogue or a licence under which government data is released. The national population and health survey of 2025 is the largest data-collection exercise in fifteen years, and its output was a report scheduled for the following year rather than a published dataset. The pattern holds across the base: the geospatial capacity programme produces trained analysts and classified imagery for ministry use, and nothing produced under it is published. Data here is produced for the state's own use, and the question of releasing it has not been put.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	A verification pass dated August 2026 confirms no comprehensive data-protection law in force (redetermination). A dated redetermination as of 1 August 2026 confirms the position is unchanged: no comprehensive data-protection law in force, no supervisory authority established and no enforcement decisions published (redetermination). A regional ministerial assessment places Eritrea's data-protection policy area at a nascent stage without legislation or regulatory oversight, grouped with Djibouti, South Sudan and Sudan against neighbours that have enacted frameworks with supervisory authorities (policy matrix). A trade regulatory profile records that Eritrea lacks a comprehensive legal framework for data protection, with no data-protection officer, impact-assessment or retention requirements (profile). This is a searched absence rather than an unexamined one: three independent assessments across four years agree.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	Computer offences sit in two articles of the general Penal Code; no dedicated cybersecurity statute exists (Penal Code). Eritrea's only identifiable computer-offence provisions are Articles 374 and 375 of the 2015 Penal Code, covering unauthorised use of a computer — unauthorised access, interception, alteration or destruction of data, interference with lawful data use — and an aggravated form (Penal Code). A country cybersecurity assessment records, item by item, no cybercrime legislation, no cybersecurity regulation, no officially recognised national computer incident response team, no national cybersecurity strategy, no governance roadmap and no responsible agency (assessment). Nothing in the window changed either position. Criminal provisions exist; the institutional apparatus a cybersecurity regime needs does not. Nor is there a strategy behind the missing statute: a country profile records no public national cybersecurity strategy, so neither the legislative nor the policy layer exists on the record.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	No digital-identity statute exists; the closest instrument is the 1992 nationality proclamation (proclamation). No dedicated digital-identity statute was located. The closest identifiable legal instrument is the Nationality Proclamation 21/1992, still in force, which provides the legal basis for nationality certification through the Department of Internal Affairs and contains no digital-identity, electronic-identity, biometric or electronic-transactions framework (proclamation). Identity cards are nonetheless required by other systems: anti-money-laundering law obliges financial institutions to identify every customer (proclamation), and a national identity card is required before a passport is issued (country guidance). So the card carries statutory weight without a statute defining it, and nothing regulates what data it holds or who may read it.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	A regional peer assessment records a state-owned financial system with no cash machines, cards or internet banking (evaluation). A regional anti-money-laundering peer assessment, adopted in July 2025 after an on-site visit in 2024, states that Eritrea's financial system is state-owned and offers simple and less sophisticated services, with no automatic teller machines, debit or credit cards, or internet banking (evaluation). There is therefore nothing for payments legislation to regulate, and the base holds no payment systems act, no e-money regulation and no licensing regime. The only draft text addressing digital finance is an unofficial consultation draft (drafts). The one instrument on the ledger is a central bank legal notice ordering cash deposits, which is currency management rather than payments law.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	No law enables data exchange between government systems; a 2022 assessment records no service bus and no cross-system exchange (dataset). A structured government-technology dataset for 2022 records no government interoperability framework and no system that exchanges data across financial management, human resources, payroll, customs, tax or social-insurance systems (dataset). A regional ministerial assessment places Eritrea's data-protection policy area at a nascent stage without legislation or regulatory oversight (policy matrix), so there is also no legal basis on which systems could lawfully share personal data. The one system that did move is closed rather than connected: the customs platform runs on an intranet architecture independent of continuous internet access (account).	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations	A review dated June 2026 records no dedicated artificial-intelligence law and no national strategy (review). A legal-status review dated 8 June 2026 states that Eritrea has no dedicated artificial-intelligence law, no national artificial-intelligence strategy, no data-protection statute and no data-protection authority, and that the nearest legal anchor is the privacy article of the 1997 constitution, which has never entered into force (review). The 2025 government artificial-intelligence readiness index, in its January 2026 edition, scores Eritrea zero on policy capacity and ranks it 193rd overall on a score of 13.69 (index). The absence is total rather than partial: no instrument, no draft and no institution with a mandate.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	No electronic transactions framework is in force; the only relevant texts are unofficial consultation drafts (drafts). A diaspora legal-reform initiative published around eighty consultation-draft acts, codes and regulations intended to reconstruct Eritrea's legal order, including a proposed commercial code and a payment systems and digital finance act addressing electronic transactions (drafts). These are unofficial and carry no legislative status. The standing assessment is that Eritrea lacks a comprehensive legal framework in the digital-trade area, with the only body holding sector-supervision power having little to no decision-making authority (profile). Nothing on the base records a government bill, a consultation or a stated intention to legislate on electronic transactions.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation	The statistics office has never operated under an enacted statistics law; a draft proclamation was recorded as pending (review). A mid-term review of statistical capacity support records that the statistical proclamation, the equivalent of a statistics act, had been submitted to government and that the formal issue was still pending (review). No later record of enactment was located at the probe date of 31 August 2026, so the national statistics office has operated for at least two decades without a statutory mandate. This matters for the surveys the base does hold: a population and health survey was carried out without a law defining who owns the data, who may access it or on what terms it is published.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	No freedom of information law has been adopted, a UN review body states plainly (review contribution). A formal contribution to Eritrea's universal periodic review states that no freedom of information law has been adopted, and that the constitutional guarantee of access to information sits in a 1997 constitution whose operative reality is the 1996 press proclamation (review contribution). The 2026 world press freedom index places Eritrea last of 180 countries and territories for the third consecutive year (index). The absence is legislative and practical at once: there is no statute, no request procedure and no appeal route, so nothing measures how much information is released.	NO CHANGE
Data protection	Data protection authority	No data-protection law and no authority. A legal survey and a regional policy matrix agree that neither exists. There is nothing to supervise and no one to supervise it. A legal survey records no data-protection statute, and a regional policy matrix places the country at the nascent end of its own scale. A digital trade regulatory profile reaches the same finding from a different direction. The absence has consequences elsewhere on this ledger. Without an authority there is no route for a complaint about personal data, no body that could authorise a transfer out of the country, and nothing that could act on synthetic or manipulated media. Each of those reads as a separate gap; all of them are this one.	NO CHANGE
Data protection	National data protection readiness	No supervisory authority exists and none is provided for; the position was re-verified in August 2026 (redetermination). The August 2026 verification pass records no comprehensive data-protection law, no supervisory authority and no published enforcement decisions (redetermination). The only body with sector-supervision power is the Communication Department, which a trade regulatory profile describes as having little to no decision-making authority (profile). The nearest legal anchor is the privacy article of the 1997 Constitution, which has never been brought into force (legal status). Readiness here is not partial: there is no law, no regulator and no route to redress.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	The sole non-signatory to the continental trade agreement, and a member of the regional body that its digital integration programme does not cover. Of 55 member states of the continental union, only this one has yet to sign the consolidated text of the free trade agreement, with 49 having signed and deposited ratification instruments. That agreement carries the continent's digital-trade and cross-border data provisions. Membership of the regional body has not produced participation either. The body's digital integration programme, the principal active track on harmonised data governance and cross-border flows, states its coverage as seven named member states and does not include this one. The regional infrastructure master plan treats the country as a gap rather than as a participant, which is the same position seen from the planners' side.	NO CHANGE
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	Nothing to harmonise with. The country has not signed the continental trade agreement and is outside the regional digital programme. Harmonisation runs through the two frameworks the country stands outside. The continental free trade agreement, whose protocols carry the digital-trade and data rules member states align to, has not been signed here. The regional body's digital integration programme, which is where harmonised data governance and cybersecurity rules are being drafted for this part of the continent, names seven participating states and not this one. There is also little on the domestic side to bring into line. No data-protection law, no electronic transactions framework and no cybersecurity strategy exist to be harmonised with anything.	NO CHANGE
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	Regional planning still treats Eritrea as a gap: cable and data-infrastructure projects carry no commitment to serve Asmara (overview). A regional digital development overview records that planned submarine and festoon cable and regional data-infrastructure projects lack a commitment to serve the region as a whole, including Asmara (overview). The regional infrastructure master plan treats Eritrea as a connectivity gap whose interconnection to Sudan, Ethiopia or submarine landing points should be implemented in the short term – language describing a planned solution rather than an existing connection, and Eritrea is not listed as an existing landing point (master plan). Six years on from that plan the base still holds no cable landing and no cross-border interconnection.	NO CHANGE
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	No transfer rule, because there is no data-protection law to carry one, and no participation in the framework that would supply one. Cross-border transfer is governed by nothing. There is no data-protection statute under which a transfer rule could sit, no authority that could authorise or refuse one, and no adequacy or localisation position of any kind. Nor is one arriving from outside. The continental agreement whose protocol addresses cross-border flows has not been signed, and the regional programme drafting harmonised rules does not cover the country. The financial system shows what that isolation looks like in practice: the regional peer assessment records a sector largely disconnected from the global financial system, with none of the instruments that would move data across a border in the first place.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Standards	National interoperability standards	A standards institution since 1995 and a regulator charged with setting technical standards. Neither has published an interoperability standard. The institutional basis exists twice over. The standards institution was constituted in 1995, and the communications proclamation of 1998 makes the ministry's communications department sole sector regulator and sets the establishment of technical standards among its objectives. What neither has produced is a published standard for how government systems exchange data. Nothing on the base names an interoperability framework, a data dictionary or a common identifier convention, and the systems that do exist run separately: customs on its own platform, tax on another, health on a third, with no exchange layer between them.	NO CHANGE
Standards	National quality standards	Standardisation rests on the 1995 proclamation establishing the standards institution as sole national organ (proclamation). The Eritrean Standards Institution was established by proclamation in 1995 as an autonomous body with legal personality and the sole national organ for standardisation, quality assurance and metrology, with powers to prepare compulsory Eritrean standards, affix conformity marks, test and certify import and export products, and inspect (proclamation). Nothing in the window amended that proclamation, and the base holds no Eritrean standard made under it that bears on digital systems, data formats or interoperability. The institution exists and its output in this field is not on the record.	NO CHANGE
Standards	Adoption of international standards	The 1995 standards proclamation adopts the international system of units as the legal measurement system (proclamation). The proclamation establishing the Eritrean Standards Institution expressly adopts the International System of Units as Eritrea's legal measurement system (proclamation). A structured government-technology dataset for 2022 records no government enterprise architecture framework, no government interoperability framework and no data quality framework (dataset). So metrology is aligned to international standards and government data practice is not; nothing on the base records adoption of an international standard for identity, payments or data exchange.	NO CHANGE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	Technical workshops in Asmara brought government, academic, private-sector and non-governmental participants into planning for the first time on the base (workshops). A water project held two rounds of geodesign workshops in Asmara in July 2026 with more than twenty government, academic, private-sector and non-governmental participants, using a geodesign platform with high-resolution hydrological modelling for two catchments, alongside a modelling training session for Eritrean technical experts (workshops). Eritrea completed its first national development plan, described as drafted through participatory, gender-responsive and results-based methods with cross-ministerial and stakeholder consultation (annual report). Both accounts are the conveners' own descriptions of process, not independent evidence of influence, and they sit against a state that systematically silences criticism (findings).	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	A press-freedom index places Eritrea last of 180 for the third consecutive year (index). The 2026 world press freedom index places Eritrea last of 180 countries and territories for the third consecutive year, alongside China and North Korea, describing a state of press freedom that has hardly changed (index). A United Nations commission of inquiry found that the government systematically silences anyone who protests, questions or criticises it and its policy, and that surveillance and punishment produce self-censorship even in private and family settings (findings). There is no forum on the record — no independent press, no permitted civil society, no online space — in which digital or data policy could be publicly argued.	NO CHANGE

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	No domestic budget line and no institution to raise one. The investment centre is dormant and the investment law effectively suspended. The external country assessment establishes the position directly: the investment centre created in 1998 is dormant and the 1994 investment law is effectively suspended, with what non-state finance arrives negotiated case by case rather than through any standing institution. No published budget names digital transformation as a line, and no revenue instrument is earmarked to it. What financing the base can see is external and project-shaped: the tax administration system and the education programme grants are both financed from outside, and both would stop with their grants.	NO CHANGE
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	A development bank mission in April 2026 reopened dialogue on a prospective financial-sector modernisation project (mission). A development bank delegation led by its East Africa director general met the senior adviser to the president and the finance minister in April 2026, with line-ministry discussions covering financial-sector modernisation and data systems, and both sides reviewing continued dialogue on a prospective project (mission). The standing umbrella instrument is the 2022-2026 cooperation framework with the United Nations development system, which provides for an "improved and integrated data ecosystem", innovation and digital technology, and public-finance support (framework). That framework expires in 2026 and the base holds no successor.	MOVEMENT
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	No blended-finance or private-investment route. The investment centre is dormant, the investment law suspended, and deals are negotiated case by case. The external country assessment is unambiguous about the machinery: the investment centre is dormant and the investment law effectively suspended, leaving no institution through which private or blended finance could be mobilised for anything, digital or otherwise. The one active engagement on the base runs the other way, from a public financier rather than a private one: a bank mission to deepen the partnership and an interim country strategy naming payment systems a priority to 2027. Neither mobilises non-state money; both propose to build the frameworks that would have to exist before any could be mobilised.	NO CHANGE

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New investments	Development-partner project financing	UNDP's statistical-capacity grant runs to 2026, beside US\$14.02m of education grants committed in 2024. The standing position is a US\$1,676,837 UNDP grant to the Government of Eritrea and the National Statistics Office, committed in 2019 with an end year of 2026. Nothing in the twelve months to 2026-08-26 records a disbursement, an extension or a successor, and no disbursement figure for it is published. The grant funds the statistical work reported under Censuses and surveys, so what movement there is shows up there rather than here. A second development partner is on the ledger after all: the Global Partnership for Education committed US\$14.02m to the education ministry through UNICEF as grant agent in April 2024, for a foundational-learning reform programme including work on the education management information system (grants).	NO CHANGE

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	Active connections reached 859,000, or 23.7% of the population, up 8.2% year on year, among the lowest rates in Africa. 2025-11-08 — DataReportal's Digital 2026 report for Eritrea puts active mobile connections at 859,000, 23.7% of the population, 49.3% of them broadband, and up 8.2% on the year. The previous edition is the comparison. The direction is upward and the level is among the lowest in Africa. Both statements are true, and the second governs what sits downstream of it: a foundational digital ID, mobile money and any service assumed to reach a citizen through a handset all rest on this figure. No operator or regulator return on the ledger tests it. Coverage is separately reported and much higher than connections: 85% of the population is covered by a mobile-cellular network but only 35% by at least third-generation service and 0% by at least fourth-generation, on 2023 international figures. Nearly a quarter of the population holds a connection inside a network that reaches five-sixths of them.	MOVEMENT
Connectivity	Internet usage	About 27% of the population uses the internet, with fixed broadband subscriptions effectively negligible. A country profile carries the 2023 international telecommunication union figures: 85% of the population covered by a mobile-cellular network, 35% by at least third-generation service and 0% by at least fourth-generation, with fixed broadband subscriptions effectively negligible, and puts internet use at about 27% of the population on a separate estimate. Coverage and use are two different numbers here and the gap between them is the finding. Five-sixths of the population live inside a mobile-cellular signal, about a third inside one carrying third-generation data and none inside fourth-generation, while about a quarter use the internet at all. With no public submarine cable landing station, the operator's internet connectivity relies on geostationary satellite links, which is the ceiling under all three. These are first figures for this base with nothing earlier behind them, so no direction can be stated.	NO CHANGE a first measurement with no earlier figure behind it

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	An entry-level mobile broadband basket costs 85% of monthly income per head, against a 2% affordability benchmark (country tables). Country-table data on 2022 pricing records Eritrea's entry-level mobile broadband basket at 85% of monthly gross national income per head, against the international affordability benchmark of 2% (country tables). That is more than forty times the benchmark, and no later Eritrea-specific figure was located at the probe date, so the base cannot say whether it has moved since 2022. The level is stated and the direction is withheld, because there is nothing to compare it against. The operator's own published terms are the only prices the base holds directly: a fixed telephone line costs a one-time payment of 882 nakfa on top of a written request, an application form and a copy of the identity card, and prepaid mobile recharge is sold in denominations of 110 and 330 nakfa, recharged by a dialled code. No tariff per minute or per gigabyte is published.	NO CHANGE a first measurement with no earlier figure behind it
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	The ministry reports about 73km of new cable laid and landline plant renovated in six towns; no independent measure of the backbone exists. 2026-05-19 — the minister responsible for communications reported 184 towers installed, about 73km of new cable laid, and landline plant renovated in six named towns and at the Naval Force Base, against a claimed cumulative investment above 35 billion Nakfa. The figures are the ministry's own, carried by state media, and nothing on the ledger tests them: no operator disclosure, no regulator return and no third-party measurement of the network appears for Eritrea in the window. EriTel remains the sole operator.	MOVEMENT on the ministry's own figures
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	Bandwidth is reported at about 1,536 Mbps after a decade of growth, and it is carried by satellite: no submarine cable lands in Eritrea. 2026-05-19 — the ministry put international bandwidth at about 1,536 Mbps, risen over the past decade. 2026-04-16 — the industry position is unchanged: Eritrea is still the only one of Africa's coastal states with no cable landing, and cable firms describe a country that does not answer landing requests. An earlier account of the same position dates it to June 2024. EriTel's international transit therefore runs on geostationary satellite, which is what a bandwidth figure of this size describes. The growth is real and the ceiling is the technology carrying it.	MOVEMENT on a ministry figure, with no cable landing behind it
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points	None. The exchange tracker records no active exchange point and no listing in the peering database, so domestic traffic leaves the country and returns. The tracker states it directly: there are no active internet exchange points in the country and none listed in the peering database. Every exchange of traffic between two domestic networks therefore travels out over international transit and back. The transit it travels on is satellite, which makes the cost of that detour unusually high in both money and delay. An exchange at the capital appears in a diaspora policy proposal alongside a cable landing and domestic data-centre capacity, and in no government document. Nothing records a peering arrangement being negotiated or an exchange being constituted.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	Starlink lists Eritrea with no planned launch date, one of seven African states without a timetable; the base holds no licence application or refusal. 2026-07-17 — Starlink's own availability map still lists Eritrea as having no planned launch date, leaving it one of seven African states with no announced timetable, all of them in North Africa and the Horn. The position is the one the base carried at the start of the window. What is not on the ledger is any Eritrean decision: no application, no refusal and no regulatory statement about satellite broadband appears, so the absence is recorded from the operator's side only.	NO CHANGE
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	One provider, and it is the state operator. Its private cloud is hosted entirely in its own data centres; no other facility is named on the base. The base now holds primary evidence that domestic hosting capacity exists, which it did not before. The state operator's private cloud service is offered in three subscription tiers and hosted entirely in the operator's own facilities. What it does not hold is any measure of that capacity. No aggregate figure, facility count, floor area, power draw or location is published for the country by anyone, and no second provider appears anywhere. A diaspora policy proposal argues for building domestic data-centre capacity, which is evidence that its author considers the present capacity inadequate rather than a measure of what it is.	NO CHANGE
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	The only national provider is the state operator, whose private cloud runs in its own data centres. No capacity figure is published at any date. National capacity and total capacity are the same number here, because the state operator is the only provider on the base. Its private cloud offers storage tiers of 100, 250 and 500 gigabytes for 20, 50 and 100 users, hosted in its own facilities. Those are subscription sizes rather than a statement of the estate behind them, and nothing published says how large that estate is, where it sits or how it is powered. The grid it draws on delivers 52 MW reliably against 74.3 MW of demand, which is the practical ceiling on how much of anything can be hosted here.	NO CHANGE
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity	The only published recovery commitment is the state operator's: a six-day recovery objective on a 90 per cent uptime service level. No government backup arrangement is published for any system, and no second site is named for any of them. The one figure the base can offer comes from the commercial side: the state operator's private cloud states a 90 per cent uptime service level and a recovery-time objective of up to six days. That is the measure of what recovery means in this market. A six-day objective is what a subscriber is promised by the country's only provider, and nothing suggests the systems the government runs itself are held to anything better. Whether the customs, tax or health systems have off-site copies at all is not stated anywhere on the base.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	The grid delivers 52 MW reliably against 74.3 MW of demand. No data centre's supply arrangement or water requirement is published. The financier's appraisal, prepared with the energy ministry and the electricity corporation, states the position: installed capacity of 157 MW with only 52 MW reliably available against demand of 74.3 MW, renewables at 6 MW, and generation almost entirely reliant on imported diesel through ageing and breakdown-prone plant. A grid meeting two thirds of the demand already placed on it is the constraint every hosted system in the country sits behind. Against that, no facility's supply arrangement, tariff, generator provision or water requirement is published for the one provider-hosted cloud on the base, and the question of whether a data centre could be powered here has not been publicly put.	NO CHANGE
Energy	Grid reliability	A financier's appraisal put 52 MW of 157 MW reliably available against 74.3 MW of demand; a twelve-centre architecture was stated in answer. Two things happened in the window and neither is a megawatt. In January the head of state set out a decentralised architecture in interview: twelve independent mini-grid power centres targeting 360 MW, each growing to 30 MW and eventually interconnected toward about 2,000 MW, framed explicitly against the inadequacy of the existing centralised grid. In February the financier's appraisal, prepared with the energy ministry and the electricity corporation, stated the position it is answering: installed capacity 157 MW with 52 MW reliably available against 74.3 MW of demand, renewables at 6 MW and generation reliant on imported diesel through ageing plant. No site, cost, financier or date has been published against the twelve centres.	MOVEMENT on paper
Energy	Rural electrification	The head of state set out twelve mini-grid centres targeting 360 MW, decentralised by design. No site, cost or date has been published. The stated approach is decentralisation rather than extension of the existing network: twelve independent mini-grid power centres, each growing to 30 MW toward a 360 MW target, to be interconnected later. For a country where the grid reaches a minority of the population, that is the right shape of answer. It remains an architecture. Nothing names a site, a cost, a financier or a date, and the appraisal from a month later describes a system still almost entirely dependent on imported diesel with renewables at 6 MW. What rural electrification there is on the base is visible only through its absence elsewhere, in the sub-regional offices without a computer.	MOVEMENT an architecture stated and nothing sited
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	The education system's own programme document calls its data collection largely paper-based and manual, with connectivity, equipment and staffing all inadequate. The government's own account is the frankest available. Its education programme document states that the management information system exists, that collection remains largely paper-based and manual, and that connectivity, equipment, staffing, analytical capacity and system design are all inadequate. The sub-national picture is older and worse: a sector note records the central ministry network reaching 30 of 55 sub-regions on dial-up with no computer at all in 25 of them. Where equipment does exist it is maintained locally rather than under contract, which is why the police force trained members from every station in computer, printer and network maintenance in June 2026.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	Three training programmes reached government staff in the window: police maintenance, geospatial analysis and records digitisation. The capacity work is real and it is all training. The police trained members drawn from every station and headquarters in computer maintenance, printer maintenance and networking. One regional administration and the national documentation centre trained 64 local-institution employees in document organisation, preservation and digital document management. A second region's administration and its sectoral branches took geospatial training framed as closing gaps in the existing information system. Alongside those, a regional economic commission trained over 25 ministry staff in geographic information systems, remote sensing and land-cover classification. What none of it amounts to yet is a system built or maintained here rather than delivered from outside.	MOVEMENT in training rather than in systems
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	There is no public national cybersecurity strategy; the one recorded incident is a government announcement. A country profile records that Eritrea has no public national cybersecurity strategy. The single incident on record is the state's own account of it: in May 2024 the government publicly announced that the country's internet system had been hit by what it called a massive cyberattack, repelled without service interruption. No incident detail, attribution, response body or computer emergency response team is named, and nothing independent corroborates either the attack or its repulse. That is the whole of what this base holds on cybersecurity for the country - one stated absence and one unverifiable claim.	NO CHANGE a first stated position with no earlier account behind it

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	No exchange layer. The systems that exist run separately: customs on its own platform and a vulnerability database in the welfare ministry. Nothing on the base names a national data exchange, a shared bus or a common identifier convention. What exists is a set of unconnected systems: the customs platform inaugurated in January 2026, which serves officials on an intranet; the welfare ministry's vulnerability database; the tax system under construction; and the health information system. There is one working instance of one system consuming another's output, and it is a legal duty rather than a technical connection: the anti-money-laundering proclamation requires financial institutions to identify every customer, which is done by presenting the national identity card at a counter.	NO CHANGE
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems	The identity card is required to open a telephone line - the one documented use of it by another system. With no foundational digital identity system in service, there is no digital credential for another system to consume. What the base can show is the paper card being used as a precondition: the state operator requires, for a fixed telephone line, a written request with address and contact number, a completed application form, a copy of the identity card and a one-time payment of 882 nakfa. That is a documentary check at a counter, not an authentication against a register, and it runs the wrong way round from what this indicator asks: the card gates access to a service rather than a service verifying against an identity system. It is the only such link the base holds. The other established dependency is internal to the state: a national identity document is required before an Eritrean passport can be issued.	NO CHANGE a first stated position with no earlier account behind it

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems	Standards-based exchange between health systems is rated not there, and patient-level systems do not interoperate with routine reporting (assessment). A health-data capacity assessment records explicitly that interoperability – standards-based data exchange between systems – is rated not there, and that patient-level systems are not interoperable with the aggregated routine health information system (assessment). A nationally owned health-data programme was launched around the 2025 population and health survey, led by the statistics office and the health ministry, intended to produce timely disaggregated evidence accessible to government and partners (case study). A survey programme is not interoperability. Nothing on the base records a standard adopted, an exchange built or a patient identifier shared between systems.	NO CHANGE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems	A teacher management information system remains planned, with a ministry delegation sent to learn the practice (workshop). An education ministry delegation attended a regional competency enhancement workshop in Lusaka in June 2025, reported in December, to learn teacher management information system practice (workshop). The education sector reform compact of September 2023 is the operative planning document behind the education management information system, which it says was used to identify barriers and prioritise reforms, and it names a teacher management information system as a planned enabling instrument (compact). Both systems are described in planning documents and neither is shown exchanging data with anything else; the teacher system is still a plan three years on.	NO CHANGE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems	A vulnerability database was established in the labour ministry; nothing states it exchanges data with any other system (results report). United Nations support helped the labour and human welfare ministry establish a vulnerability database to collect, collate and analyse gender-segregated data on persons with disabilities, single-women-headed households and other vulnerable groups (results report). The report does not state that the database exchanges data with the population registers, the health information system or any payment mechanism, and a 2022 structured assessment records no system exchanging data across social insurance or payroll (dataset). So the base holds one database and no exchange, which is the whole of what can be said.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position with nothing on exchange
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	The base holds no operational foundational digital ID, a position profiled in July 2025 and untouched since. 2025-07-26 – a digital identity index profile found no operational foundational identity system and set out what one would face: low connectivity and mobile penetration, thin digital infrastructure, a telecom monopoly and weak civil registration. Nothing in the twelve months to 2026-08-26 changes that. No enrolment programme, procurement, pilot or legal instrument on digital identity appears on the ledger, so the standing position is carried forward on a single profile written just before the window opened.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	With no foundational digital system in service, the credential is a card issued since 1992, handwritten until 2014. The same 2025-07-26 profile that finds no operational foundational identity system names weak civil registration among the barriers a future one would face, which is the nearest the base comes to a statement about coverage. No enrolment figure exists to report, because there is nothing to enrol into. The population counting the base does hold is the survey work reported under Censuses and surveys, which is a statistical exercise and not a register. The credential that does exist is documented: identity cards are issued by the Department of Immigration and Nationality, were first issued in 1992 and were handwritten until 2014, with applicants submitting a municipality letter, a birth certificate and proof of citizenship to one of twelve branch offices which forward the application to headquarters for approval. A newer electronic card carries a laser-engraved photograph, the holder's fingerprint and a unique serial number, and citizens aged 18 and over are required to hold one. No issuance volume, coverage rate or database behind the card is on record at any date, and the fullest account of the system is eight years old.	NO CHANGE
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	The card is issued and maintained on paper. Most holders still carry the old handwritten card, with a long application backlog. The standing position is set out in the external civil-documents reference: the identity card is issued by the immigration and nationality department at a fee of 100 nakfa, a plastic card with hologram and fingerprint was introduced late in 2015 for those aged 18 and over, and very few new cards are in circulation, most people still holding the old handwritten cards, with a long backlog of applications. A credential most of whose holders carry a handwritten version is not maintained in the sense this indicator asks about. There is no renewal cycle, no revocation route and no register behind it that could support either. No foundational digital identity programme is on the base to replace it.	NO CHANGE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	Authentication is a card shown at a counter. The anti-money-laundering proclamation requires it of banks; no electronic verification exists. The only authentication duty on the base is the anti-money-laundering proclamation's: financial institutions must establish customer due-diligence and identification policies for every account and transaction relationship, with the central bank supervising. The regional peer assessment describes the identity card as the document used to discharge it. That is authentication done by eye. There is no verification service, no electronic signature framework and no credential that could be checked against a register, and the financial system it serves has no automatic teller machines, cards or internet banking to check one at. Most cardholders carry a handwritten card.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth	Birth registration and the identity card are separate systems, the card issued from age 18. Nothing links them. There is no credential that follows a person from birth. Civil registration of births exists and is partial; the identity card is a separate document issued from age 18 by the immigration and nationality department at a fee of 100 nakfa, and no number carries from one to the other. Nor is anything being built that would. No foundational digital identity programme, pilot or vendor engagement is on the base. The registers that do exist are held at sub-national level, and the children's rights committee's observations are the most recent external assessment of what they cover.	NO CHANGE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id	Birth registration feeds the regional population registers, and a national identity card is required before a passport is issued (guidance). Operational country guidance published in March 2026 states that Eritrea issues national identity cards and that a national identity document is required before an Eritrean passport can be issued (guidance). Birth registration feeds the zoba population registers through the local family register and transfer documents, and the identity and residence cards are printed extracts of those registers (technical description). The chain therefore exists but is regional rather than national, and the base holds no birth-registration coverage rate, so how many children enter it is not known. What feeds them is not measured: the 2025 vital statistics return leaves birth and death registration completeness blank, and the only structural account, from 2002, records registration under a transitional civil code in eight urban areas only, optional rather than obligatory, kept for administrative purposes with no statistical data retained. An identity layer fed by a registration system of unknown coverage inherits that unknown.	NO CHANGE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	One system consumes the credential: banks, under the customer identification duty. It is consumed by being shown, not by being checked. The clearest standing example of the national credential being used by a system other than the one that issues it is the anti-money-laundering proclamation, which requires financial institutions to identify the customer behind every account and transaction relationship. Regional assessment describes the identity card as the document that discharges the duty in practice. Beyond that, nothing. No public service on the base requires the card, no register keys to its number, and there is no citizen-facing online service that could ask for it. Use by other systems here means a photocopy in a bank file.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The Bank of Eritrea gave holders of cash outside the banking system until 31 July 2026 to deposit it, on pain of legal action. 2026-07-02 — a legal notice from the Bank of Eritrea ordered cash held outside banks deposited by 31 July 2026, with legal action threatened against holders who do not comply. The notice defines no threshold for the excessive holding it names and states no enforcement mechanism. It is the only central-bank action on this ledger, and it addresses the cash economy rather than any payment system: no named mobile-money or digital-payments service appears anywhere on the base for Eritrea.	MOVEMENT an instrument aimed at the cash economy rather than at payment

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	Eritrea is absent from the continental inventory of instant payment systems, so no rail exists for government-to-person payment (inventory). The annual continental inventory of live and planned instant payment systems, covering systems with live transactions as of June 2024, does not list Eritrea among the 31 operating systems across 26 countries, and does not identify it among those supporting government-to-person functionality (inventory). The financial system it would run on has no cash machines, cards or internet banking (evaluation). Government payments to people are therefore made in cash, and nothing on the base records a plan to change that.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	The tax administration system reached 67.21 per cent disbursement with software and hardware installed by June 2026, its progress rated satisfactory. The financier's own supervision report is the most authoritative current statement of the system's standing: software and hardware delivery and installation complete, the first release's requirements specification complete, disbursement at 67.21 per cent as of June 2026, and implementation progress rated satisfactory. That is real movement on a project approved in September 2023. What it does not yet show is revenue collected through it. No taxpayer register size is published at any date, no filing or payment volume is reported, and the payment systems the money would move over are themselves named a priority for construction to 2027. Collection remains a counter transaction.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality	Neither exists. The regional assessment records a state-owned sector with no cards and no internet banking, and no mobile-money service is licensed. The regional peer assessment, following an on-site visit in 2024, states that the financial system is state-owned and offers simple and less sophisticated services with no automatic teller machines, debit or credit cards or internet banking, and that the financial intelligence unit is not yet operational. Business-to-business and business-to-government payment are not partially available here; the instruments they would run on do not exist. No named mobile-money operator, licence or pilot appears anywhere on the base. The financier's country strategy names payment systems an explicit priority for 2025 to 2027, which is a statement that the work has not started.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	There is no digital payment rail of any kind; a modernisation project remains prospective (mission). A development bank delegation visited in April 2026 and reviewed continued dialogue on a prospective financial sector modernisation project, with discussions covering financial-sector modernisation and data systems (mission). The project is prospective, not approved. The system it would modernise has no cash machines, debit or credit cards, or internet banking (evaluation), and Eritrea does not appear in the continental instant-payments inventory (inventory). Person-to-person, person-to-government and person-to-business payment are all cash transactions here, and the base records no exception. The absence was searched again and stands: a sector account of the country's fintech position in March 2026 names no mobile money or digital payments service, records online banking, cash machines and mobile financial applications as largely absent, and puts total online commerce at under US\$10m a year. A dated search finding nothing is a different statement from an unexamined gap, and this is now the second.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	More than 70% of Eritreans are estimated to remain unbanked, with cash dominating economic activity. A trade account of the country's position in 2026 estimates that more than 70% of Eritreans remain unbanked, on a highly centralised financial system of a small number of state-owned banks, one of which provides the majority of retail banking. It links that structure to limited competition, minimal innovation and heavy reliance on manual processes, with online banking, cash machines and mobile financial applications largely absent so cash continues to dominate. The digital economy it would serve is correspondingly small: total online commerce is estimated at under US\$10m a year, and mobile penetration was just under 60% of population in 2022, ranked 191st of 209 economies. These are a trade publication's estimates, not a central bank or survey series, and no official financial inclusion measurement for the country is held at any date. The figure is reported for what it is.	NO CHANGE a first measurement with no earlier figure behind it
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	The regional assessment finds the sector largely disconnected from the global financial system, with no cards and no internet banking to connect it. The peer assessment adopted in July 2025 states the position plainly: a state-owned financial system offering simple and less sophisticated services, with no automatic teller machines, debit or credit cards or internet banking, and largely disconnected from the global financial system. Its financial intelligence unit is not yet operational. Nothing else on the base bears on cross-border payment. There is no correspondent arrangement named, no remittance corridor described and no regional settlement scheme the country participates in, which is consistent with its position outside the continental trade agreement and outside the regional digital programme.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	No payment consumer-protection rule, because there are no payment products. The only complaint route on the base is the state operator's internet complaint form. There is nothing for a payments consumer-protection regime to protect. The regional assessment records a state-owned sector with no cards and no internet banking, and no mobile-money service is licensed. No dispute, chargeback or redress rule appears anywhere. The one working consumer route the base holds belongs to the telecommunications side: the state operator's internet complaint form, alongside its published terms of access to services. Neither is a financial protection, and neither sits under a regulator with power to enforce.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Population register	Population registration runs on six separate regional registers with no central national register (technical description). Eritrea's population registration has been digital at regional level since 2001: six separate registers, one per zoba, each recording an identity number, family and resident numbers, nationality and civil data, from which residence cards and family identity cards are printed as extracts. Birth registration feeds them through the local family register. There is no central national register (technical description). A regional treaty body, reviewing Eritrea's fourth periodic report in April 2026, recognised the development of a five-year strategic civil registration and vital statistics plan for 2024-2028 (concluding observations). A country-of-origin report carries a dedicated section on the register and the cards drawn from it (report). The base holds no coverage rate and no statement that the six registers reconcile with one another.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Civil register	The 2025 vital statistics return leaves registration completeness blank; the only structural account of the system is from 2002. The country's return to the United Nations vital statistics questionnaire for reporting year 2025 leaves the completeness fields for birth and death registration blank, so no registration completeness estimate is reported at all - which is itself the most current statement the base has. The only description of the system's shape is twenty-four years old and is stated as such: birth registration then ran under a transitional civil code in eight named urban areas only and not in rural areas, was optional rather than obligatory even there, was kept for administrative purposes with no statistical data retained, and the urban offices did not know their own annual registered births. The same account records that no proper registration system or population census had been conducted before or since independence in 1991. Nothing between those two dates is held, so whether the 2002 position still describes the system cannot be stated - only that nobody has reported a completeness figure since.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Address register	Eritrea does not appear on the postal union's list of countries operating a postcode system (reference). The Universal Postal Union's addressing reference, dated August 2026, does not list Eritrea among the countries that require or use a postal-code system, establishing that no national postcode system exists (reference). The document does not itself state whether any other national addressing scheme operates, and the base holds nothing else on the question — no street-naming programme, no digital addressing initiative and no geocoding of the population registers.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Business register	The statutory business register is still operated manually, with no registration website and clearance through six offices (assessment). An investment climate assessment records that Eritrea has no business-registration website and requires manual registration and clearance through six government offices (assessment). The register itself is statutory: a 2002 proclamation requires the trade ministry to establish and maintain a business information register covering trade, manufacturing, services, fisheries and commercial farming, specifying the fields collected, annual reporting obligations, penalties and judicial review (proclamation). A register that exists in law and on paper is a different thing from a digital one, and nothing on the base records the register being computerised or published.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Social protection register	A vulnerability database in the welfare ministry collecting gender-segregated data, under a social protection policy running to 2026. The register exists and its shape is described in the government's own periodic report: a national social protection policy and strategic plan for 2022 to 2026, a disability policy revised in 2021, and accession to the disability rights convention in December 2024. Behind them sits the labour and welfare ministry's vulnerability database, collecting gender-segregated data on persons with disabilities and other vulnerable groups. Nothing in the window changed its coverage, its size or its operation. The external committee's observations of July 2026 are an assessment of the framework rather than a change to it, and record the state's position that it hosts no refugee, asylum-seeking or internally displaced children.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Electoral register	The electoral law provides for a voter register, and nothing records one ever having been compiled (electoral law). The Eritrean electoral law establishes an independent electoral commission responsible for preparing and administering the voter register, issuing voting cards, and closing and publicly displaying the register for inspection (electoral law). The base holds no record of a national election held under it, no commission constituted and no register compiled. The hosted text of the law is itself undated. This is a register that exists as a statutory design and not as a system.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Tax register	The system that would hold it reached 67.21 per cent disbursement with hardware and software installed. No register size is published at any date. The taxpayer register is being built rather than counted. The financier's supervision report records software and hardware delivered and installed, the first release's requirements specification complete, and disbursement at 67.21 per cent as of June 2026, with implementation progress rated satisfactory against a project approved in September 2023. What no source states is how many taxpayers are registered, at this or any earlier date, or what proportion of economic activity the register reaches. Until the first release runs there is no register to measure, and the base carries the project's progress in place of the thing it will produce.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Land register	Land registration rests on the 1997 proclamation establishing the cadastral office, with no statement of its operational extent (proclamation). The 1997 land registration proclamation established the Cadastral Office under the land, water and environment ministry, responsible for registering all land, rights over land and transfers of property, following the 1994 change of tenure under which all land belongs to the state with allocable private rights (proclamation). The proclamation establishes the office and not the register's reach. The base holds no parcel count, no coverage figure and no statement that the register is held digitally.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Health	The national laboratory built genomic sequencing capacity and applied it nationally to malaria and resistance surveillance for the first time (report). Eritrea's national health laboratory has built genomic sequencing capacity since 2024, training 15 professionals — 13 from the health ministry and two from agriculture — and applying the capability to malaria and antimicrobial-resistance surveillance for the first time nationally (report). The standing system is the National Health Information System under the minister's office, comprising health information, technology and system-development units with parallel structures at regional level, collecting from all health facilities by paper and electronic channels. The district platform reached about 40% of secondary-level and above facilities at the plan's writing. The base holds no later coverage figure, so that reading is five years old and the direction since is unknown.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Education	A consultancy was sought in June 2026 for analytical support to the education information system, against weaknesses the ministry's own programme document names. The request for proposal is targeted work against a diagnosis the government has already made. It seeks a consultant for analytical support to the education management information system, responding to identified weaknesses in analysis, gender disaggregation and data use, and requiring analysis of teacher deployment and attrition by gender and location, ministry workshops and a validated policy brief, with a deadline in July 2026. The diagnosis is the government's own: its programme document states that the system exists but that collection remains largely paper-based and manual, with connectivity, equipment, staffing, analytical capacity and system design all inadequate. A teacher management workshop in December 2025 preceded it.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection	The vulnerability database is the system. The children's rights committee's observations are the most recent external assessment of what it supports. What exists is a register rather than a management system: the labour and welfare ministry's vulnerability database, collecting gender-segregated data on persons with disabilities and other vulnerable groups, under a social protection policy and strategic plan running to 2026. The children's rights committee's concluding observations, adopted at the end of January 2025, are the base's most recent external assessment of the data behind social services. They also record that the 2015 penal, civil and procedural codes are not yet in force, which leaves the sector operating under transitional law. Nothing in the window records a caseload figure, a payment record or an eligibility rule.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	None. The justice ministry's own review of its year names advancing the use of technology and describes no system. The absence is established by the ministry itself. Its 2024 activity review and 2025 plan names advancing the use of technology among its priority programmes and does not name or describe any court case-management or justice management information system. That is the best available statement of the sector's standing, and what it establishes is that no such system is on the record. The law the sector applies compounds it. The children's rights committee records that the 2015 penal, civil and procedural codes are not yet in force, the amended transitional penal code remaining operative — which also leaves the country without an operative statute reaching computer or electronic offences.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	Bids for an integrated tax administration system were invited in September 2023; no award or go-live has followed. 2023-09-07 - the finance ministry invited sealed bids for the supply, installation and configuration of an integrated tax administration system with its hardware and IT equipment, under a development bank governance-sector project. The scope is a full replacement, not an add-on: implementation services with training, change management and quality assurance; cleaning, validation and migration of legacy data from the current system; deployment from a main production site to other locations in the capital and to every inland revenue office in the zobas; data replication and business continuity for disaster recovery; and support under a service level agreement. Three years on, no contract award, go-live date or operating account is on the record. The procurement notice is the whole of what the base holds on tax administration systems for this country, and a tender with no reported outcome is what the value here rests on.	STALLED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	ASYCUDA World was inaugurated on 8 January 2026, replacing customs software dating from 2007, with the source code transferred to the government. 2026-01-08 — ASYCUDA World entered service, replacing customs software in use since 2007. UNDP supported the implementation and the source code was transferred in full to the Eritrean government, which is the part worth recording: the system is nationally held rather than run on the country's behalf. It is the only sectoral management information system on this ledger, and nothing states what it connects to — no revenue system, no business register and no trade single window appears for Eritrea.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Land	The cadastral office dates from 1997. What moved was training: land ministry staff in geospatial analysis, twice in the window. The register itself is unchanged: a cadastral office and land register constituted by proclamation in 1997, with no published statement of coverage, digitisation or parcel count at any date. What moved is the analytical capacity around it. A four-week workshop trained over 25 land, water and environment ministry staff in geographic information systems, remote sensing, land use and land cover classification and watershed analysis, the second phase of a partnership with a regional economic commission. A parallel course reached experts from six ministries plus the cartographic centre and regional administrations, and a third extended it to a region in July. All of it sits under a domesticated geospatial framework action plan.	MOVEMENT in the capacity behind it rather than in the system
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	The only operating government digital system on the base is an internal customs platform (account). Eritrea inaugurated a customs platform in January 2026, replacing a paper-based system operational since 2007, with full source-code transfer to the government, an intranet architecture connecting all customs stations independent of continuous internet access, solar-powered servers and a ten-month capacity-building programme (account). It serves customs officials, not the public. The standing external measurement is the 2024 United Nations e-government survey (technical appendix); its country-level index values for Eritrea are not in the text held, so the base names the measurement without carrying its numbers. No online government service a citizen could use is recorded anywhere on the base.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position with no citizen-facing service on the base

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	The last assessment of sub-national office ICT found no computer at all in 25 of 55 sub-regional offices (sector note). A sector assessment recorded a central ministry local network and internet server, six regional offices and 30 of 55 sub-regional offices connected by dial-up modem, no computer at all in 25 of 55 sub-regional offices, and no systematic maintenance arrangement (sector note). It is the clearest authoritative assessment of ICT at sub-national government offices located, and it dates from 2002. Nothing later on the base measures the same thing. The direction of travel over twenty-four years is therefore not something the base can state, which is itself the finding.	NO CHANGE the only assessment on the base is more than two decades old

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records	Two regional administrations took records training in the window: 64 local-institution employees in document management, then a second region on geospatial systems. One regional administration, with the national research and documentation centre, trained 64 employees of local institutions in document organisation, preservation, evaluation and digital document management in September 2025. In July 2026 a second region's administration and its sectoral branches took geospatial training framed as addressing gaps in the existing information system and improving documentation practices. Both are capacity-building rather than an operating digitised-records system, and the standing position they build on is severe: a sector note records the central ministry network reaching 30 of 55 sub-regions on dial-up, with no computer at all in 25 of them. Nothing records a local register being converted.	MOVEMENT in training rather than in records
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics	A smartphone application for adverse-event reporting was introduced to over 60 national and zonal staff, replacing paper reporting. The workshop of October 2025 introduced a smartphone application for reporting adverse events following immunisation and adverse drug reactions, to over 60 participants including national and zonal focal points, regulatory officers and technology specialists, framed explicitly as the transition from paper-based to digital reporting. Zonal focal points are the level at which rural clinics report, which is what makes this reach beyond the capital. An independent long-form account reports the introduction of a digital health policy and a health technology strategic plan for 2026 to 2030; no health ministry or health agency source corroborates it, so it is carried as a claim rather than as a fact. The national health information system is unchanged.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools	Collection is largely paper-based and manual by the ministry's own account, with connectivity, equipment and staffing named inadequate. Nothing on the base records a rural school digitised, connected or equipped. The government's own programme document describes the system that would collect from them: largely paper-based and manual, with connectivity, equipment, staffing, analytical capacity and system design all inadequate, to be strengthened through improved routine collection and use. The policy above it exists — a policy for technology in education — and names technology in education as a distinct programme area within secondary and general education. What no source supplies is a count of schools with equipment or a connection, at any level, rural or otherwise. The grants financing the work are directed at the information system rather than at the schools.	NO CHANGE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices	Population registers are held at sub-national level and described as digital in one external report; nothing states their coverage or reach. Sub-national population registers exist and one external report describes them as digital, which is the strongest statement the base holds. What it does not hold is any account of how far down that reaches: no sub-region is named, no coverage figure is given, and birth registration itself is partial. The children's rights committee's observations of July 2026 are the most recent external assessment of civil registration. Against them stands the sub-national equipment position: 30 of 55 sub-regions on dial-up and no computer at all in 25. Where the offices have no computer, the register is not digital at the point it is written.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations	The police trained members from every station in the country in computer, printer and network maintenance in June 2026. The training reached beyond the capital by design: members drawn from all police stations across the country and from headquarters, in computer maintenance, printer maintenance and computer networking. Stations are evidently expected to keep equipment and network functions working without a contractor. What the base does not establish is that record capture is live at station level. The state's own national human rights report records the force having established police centres in 53 sub-regions and 34 further stations in remote areas, with a computerised system managing crime records, vehicle registration, traffic violations and personnel — but does not link that system to the remote stations. Training people to maintain equipment is not the same as showing the system reaches them.	MOVEMENT in maintenance skills rather than in systems

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	One deployment, in agriculture: an expert system for agricultural strategic information. No administrative use is recorded and no policy governs it. The single instance on the base is sectoral and five years old: an agricultural expert system reported in 2021. Nothing records a model used in administration — no case triage, no register matching, no document processing in any ministry. The governing position is empty in both directions. A legal-status review of June 2026 and a readiness index agree that neither an artificial intelligence law nor a strategy exists, the index scoring policy capacity at zero. Where models do appear in public life they arrive from outside: a private institute reports about 50 graduates in 2026 from new introductory courses, some producing commercial animation.	NO CHANGE
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	One agricultural expert system, described by the ministry as part of artificial intelligence, gives farmers guidance when extension workers are unavailable (account). The agriculture ministry's strategic information system division, established in 2019, includes an agricultural expert system that the ministry itself describes as part of artificial intelligence, used to give farmers guidance when extension workers are unavailable (account). It is the only documented instance of a named artificial-intelligence component inside an Eritrean sectoral management information system, and the account is the ministry's own with nothing testing its use or effect. The base holds no later statement of whether the system still runs.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position and the only such system on the base
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	Eri-Chat, an offline AI application built by a ministry developer, launched in April 2025 and was shown at an Asmara diplomatic event in October. 2025-11-01 — a profile of the developer Naod Goitom Isaac describes Eri-Chat, an offline AI application launched in April 2025 and shown to ambassadors and UN officials at an Asmara UN Day event on 24 October 2025. It works in English only; local-language support waits on training data the developer says does not exist in sufficient quantity. It is one application written by a single software developer at the Ministry of Information rather than a national programme, and it is the only AI system of any kind on this ledger.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Control of AI abuse	AI-generated war imagery circulated widely, met only by external fact-checking; no domestic law or takedown route exists (fact check). A fact-checking service documented AI-generated images and videos through 2026 — tanks entering Assab, the president pursued by a foreign army chief, troops surrendering — circulating from both pro-Ethiopian and pro-Eritrean accounts, drawing large engagement and inflaming war narratives (fact check). The response on the record is entirely external. Eritrea has no artificial-intelligence law, no national strategy and no regulator (review), and no data-protection authority to which a person depicted could complain (redetermination). There is no domestic mechanism of any kind on the base for identifying, labelling or removing synthetic media.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position and the only response on the record is external
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	The 1998 proclamation makes developing national communications capability an objective. Twenty-eight years on, no manufacturer or licensed supplier is named on the base. The legal basis is the founding sector law: the communications proclamation makes the ministry's communications department sole regulator over telecommunications, broadcasting and post, and sets the establishment of technical standards and the development of the country's communications capabilities, industries and skills among its objectives, through operator licensing, equipment supplier and installer permits and a rural telecommunications fund. What has been produced under it is software rather than hardware, and small: a developer group publishing Tigrinya-language educational applications and a virtual-reality rendering of national heritage. No manufacturer, assembler or licensed equipment supplier appears anywhere on the base.	NO CHANGE
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	One technology hub is documented: a youth union training centre teaching electronics, programming and robotics (account). The Youth Innovation and Entrepreneurship Hub, established in 2023 by the national union of Eritrean youth and students, runs three levels of six-month technical training in electronics, Python, Scratch, robotics and soldering, primarily for students in grades 9 to 11 (account). It is the clearest documented operating technology hub in Eritrea, and it is a training centre rather than an incubator: nothing on the base records a company founded through it, investment placed or a product taken to market. No commercial or university-attached hub is recorded anywhere.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position and one hub on the base
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	A self-organised collective released five Tigrinya-language education applications built to the national curriculum, with no stated funding or distribution channel. 2026-08-15 — an interview carried by the state information ministry describes five applications from the Shambko Apps Group: literacy, puzzle, cultural-heritage and arithmetic tools written against the national curriculum, with a stated plan to extend them to Eritrea's eight other national languages. The group is a private collective rather than a state programme. Nothing is stated about download counts, distribution channel or funding, and no hub, incubator, investor or company registration appears elsewhere on the ledger — so this is one collective on the record, not evidence of a startup base.	MOVEMENT

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	One regional training reached 108 government employees in computer technology and networking, 63 of them women (report). A workers' confederation branch provided vocational training in computer technology and computer networking to 108 government employees and force members, 63 of them women, reported in November 2025 (report). It is the clearest documented evidence that digital training reaching government employees exists, and it is a regional activity rather than a permanent nationwide scheme; no standing instrument was located at the probe date. The 2005 education ICT policy requires training only for education-sector staff (policy). The base holds one course and no measure of civil-service digital skills.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position and it records one regional activity, not a scheme
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	No population measure exists. What the base counts is people who paid or were posted: civil servants and fee-paying students. Nothing on the base measures digital skill in the population — no survey, no index entry, no schooling indicator. What it holds instead are two channels that reach particular groups. Government employees receive vocational training in one region, and the civil service has been the main route to skills throughout. Outside it, a private technology institute with four branches across two cities graduates roughly 700 young people a year from its computer technology, electrical and electronic and audio-visual departments. Both are real; neither is a population. With mobile connections the only published penetration figure and internet use low, the general position is inferred rather than measured.	NO CHANGE
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	The ministry's own overview names technology in education as a programme area; the captured text does not reach what it contains. The education ministry's status overview names information technology in education as a distinct programme area within secondary and general education, alongside technical and vocational training and curriculum reform. The capture reaches page eleven and not that section, so the base holds the programme's existence and not its content: no syllabus, no hours, no equipment standard and no school count. Training that is documented happens outside the school system. A private institute with four branches graduates roughly 700 a year from technology departments, which is a fee-paying route rather than a secondary curriculum. The policy for technology in education governs the area without stating its reach.	NO CHANGE
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	The engineering college showed 26 research papers and 29 demonstrations from 1,694 students, 39% of them women (report). Mai Nefhi College of Engineering and Technology held its engineering day in May 2026 under the theme of innovation for national development, showing 26 research papers and engineering solutions, 32 illustrations and 29 engineering demonstrations, from a college of 1,694 students of whom 39% are women, across five-year degree and three-year diploma programmes (report). The qualifications themselves are longstanding: the institute of technology, established in 2004 and restructured into autonomous colleges in 2018, offers computer engineering degrees and computer, communication and electrical technology diplomas (account). The base holds student numbers and event output, and no graduate count or employment destination.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	The engineering college graduated 297 students, a quarter of them women, including computer science and engineering degrees. The nineteenth commencement of the principal engineering college produced 297 graduates, 25 per cent of them women, comprising 289 first degrees including computer science and engineering and eight diplomas including computer application technology and computer hardware and networking technology. It is the clearest count of a technology cohort the base has ever held for this country. Alongside it, a private institute graduates roughly 700 a year from technology departments, with named alumni opening their own technology shops and about 50 graduates in 2026 from new introductory artificial intelligence courses. Those are the two pipelines that can be counted. Where either cohort goes afterwards is not published, and national service assignment governs much of it.	MOVEMENT
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	The 2002 proclamation gives a state agency a research mandate covering information science. What the base records happening under it is external training. The legal foundation is strong and dormant. The 2002 proclamation establishes a national science and technology council chaired by the head of state, a development agency and an advisory board, and gives the agency's research office a mandate covering information science and technology, with power to establish research and education institutions in the field. No output of that agency appears on the base. What research capacity is visible is delivered from outside — geospatial workshops run by a regional economic commission — or written from the diaspora, as with a long-form proposal for a national digital infrastructure agenda published by an independent outlet rather than a constituted body. Independent domestic publication is itself absent.	NO CHANGE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals	The state telecommunications provider runs a web complaint form for internet faults; no whole-of-government channel exists (complaint hub). The sole state telecommunications provider operates a live web form for internet-connectivity, website-access and web-application problems, with telephone and email alternatives (complaint hub). It is the clearest operational digital feedback channel located, and it is narrowly sector-specific. Nothing on the base records a government complaint portal, a service-standards charter or a published response record, and there is no freedom of information law under which an unanswered complaint could be pursued (review contribution). The base holds no volume of complaints made or resolved.	NO CHANGE a first statement of the position and the channel is one operator's, not government's

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy	Participation happens where the government convenes it, as in a geodesign workshop on water. Independent discussion is absent. Two things are true at once. There is convened participation: a geodesign workshop in the capital brought non-governmental contributors into a planning exercise, and the development programme's annual report describes consultation on the national development plan. And there is no forum outside that. A press-freedom index places the country last of 180 for a third consecutive year, and a commission of inquiry found systematic silencing of criticism. No independent publication, permitted civil-society body or public forum argues digital or data policy. Participation here means being invited, and nothing in the window changed who does the inviting.	NO CHANGE
Access to services	Gender equity	A quarter of the engineering college's 297 graduates were women, and a June 2026 consultancy requires gender-disaggregated analysis. The window produced one count and one commitment to counting. The engineering college's commencement reported 297 graduates with 25 per cent of them women. The education ministry's consultancy request requires analysis of teacher deployment and attrition by gender and location, naming weak gender disaggregation as one of the faults it is answering. Behind both sits a register that already disaggregates: the welfare ministry's vulnerability database collects gender-segregated data. What none of this reaches is access itself. No sex-disaggregated figure for phone ownership, internet use or account holding is published for the country at any date.	MOVEMENT in what is measured rather than in access
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities	A policy revised in 2021, convention accession in December 2024 and a social protection plan to 2026, with a register behind them. The framework is documented in the government's own periodic report: a national policy for persons with disabilities revised in 2021 with a translation in 2023, accession to the disability rights convention on 20 December 2024, and a national social protection policy and strategic plan for 2022 to 2026. The register behind it is the labour and welfare ministry's vulnerability database, collecting gender-segregated data on persons with disabilities. Nothing in it reaches digital access. No accessibility standard governs a public website or service, no assistive-technology provision is described, and the external committee's July 2026 observations assess the framework without recording a change to it.	NO CHANGE
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	No framework and no accession. The country is not party to the refugee conventions and has no national protection law; displacement runs outward. The refugee agency's legal and governance profile records that the country is not party to the refugee convention, its protocol or the regional refugee convention, has no national legal framework addressing refugee or asylum-seeker protection, and hosts a population of 119 refugees. The displacement that matters here is outward. By December 2025 the agency was aware of over 679,000 refugees and asylum-seekers from the country worldwide, and its guidance note of April 2026 supersedes eligibility guidelines dating from 2011. The children's rights committee records the state's position that it hosts no refugee, asylum-seeking or internally displaced children and recommends it establish status-determination procedures.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	The divide is between the capital and everywhere else. Sub-regional offices without computers sit behind a grid short of its own demand. No programme on the base is directed at closing a divide. The operator continues expanding its network, and mobile connections are the only penetration figure published, but nothing states a coverage obligation, a universal-service disbursement or a rural target. The structural position is unchanged and severe. A sector note records the central ministry network reaching 30 of 55 sub-regions on dial-up with no computer at all in 25 of them. The grid delivers 52 MW reliably against 74.3 MW of demand, and the twelve mini-grid centres proposed in answer have no site or date against them. Electricity comes before access.	NO CHANGE

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics	A two-week training in national accounts compilation and a database system reached the statistics office in January 2026. No statistics law sits under it. The training delivered to the national statistics office covered compilation of output by the production approach under the 2008 international standard, and deployment of a national accounts database system over two weeks in January 2026. That is methodology and infrastructure together, and it is the most substantial statistical capacity work the base records. It has no statutory foundation. A mid-term review recorded the draft statistical proclamation as submitted and pending in 2007, and no later enactment has been located, so the office operates without a statutory mandate. The population and health survey completed in 2025 is the other half of the picture: capacity being built without a strategy naming what it is for.	MOVEMENT
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	The fourth Eritrea Population and Health Survey completed fieldwork in 9,794 households across all six regions, with the report due in 2026. 2026-05-08 — the National Statistics Office reported the fourth Eritrea Population and Health Survey complete: 9,794 households across 405 enumeration areas, a 98.4% household completion rate, and collection by computer-assisted personal interview. Around 400 tables over 20 chapters are drafted, with writing, printing and dissemination scheduled through 2026, so the fieldwork is finished and the published output is not. Technical support came from UNECA and an Oslo consultancy under the UNDP-led Joint Programme on Data for Development. It is the most substantial statistical work the base holds for Eritrea.	MOVEMENT
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	The statistics office compiled national accounts for 2023 and began collection for 2024, the only administrative statistical production the base records. 2026-05-08 — alongside the household survey, the National Statistics Office is reported to have compiled the 2023 national accounts and started data collection for 2024. That is the whole of the ledger's evidence on statistics drawn from administrative sources, and it is second-hand: the accounts themselves are not on the base, and no statement of which administrative systems feed them appears either. No statistics law and no national strategy for the development of statistics is on record for Eritrea, so this production rests on the office's own practice.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Open data	Use of open data	Data is produced for the state's own use. The 2025 population and health survey was to report in 2026, with no dataset released. The largest data exercise in fifteen years shows the pattern. The government-led population and health survey of 2025 was run by the statistics office and the health ministry with an international agency covering half of a US\$535,000 budget, as a nationally representative household collection intended to close disaggregated-data gaps for policy and development-goal tracking. Its report was scheduled for 2026; no dataset, licence or catalogue entry accompanies it. Nothing else on the base is published as data either. The geospatial programme produces classified imagery and trained analysts for ministry use, and no open data policy or portal was located.	NO CHANGE
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data	A rainfall dataset refreshed every two weeks and an August advisory forecasting below-normal rain over the west. Both are produced abroad. Satellite data reaches agriculture here through two external products. A food agency dataset carries dekadal rainfall indicators computed from satellite precipitation imagery blended with station data and short-term forecasts, aggregated to subnational units and refreshed roughly every two weeks. A regional climate centre's advisory of August 2026 uses precipitation index analysis with satellite-derived soil-moisture and vegetation-stress monitoring to raise alert levels and forecast below-normal rainfall over the west. The domestic side is capacity rather than product: ministry staff trained in remote sensing, land-cover classification and watershed analysis, and an agricultural expert system reported in 2021. Nothing records a national product built from either.	MOVEMENT
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data	A modern national meteorological service is listed among forward strategies, not among institutions. The satellite monitoring that covers the country is produced abroad. The country's own delegation statement to the desertification convention lists setting up a modern national meteorological service among its forward strategies, which places a modern service as an objective rather than an operating institution; what exists is split between a civil aviation meteorological service and an agricultural meteorology unit. The monitoring itself is external and active. A regional climate centre's advisory of August 2026 uses precipitation index analysis and satellite-derived soil-moisture and vegetation-stress monitoring to raise alert levels and forecast below-normal rainfall over the west of the country, and a food agency publishes satellite-derived rainfall indicators by subnational unit roughly every two weeks. The country is covered; it does not do the covering.	MOVEMENT

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	The foreign minister met a senior presidential adviser for African affairs in September 2025, discussing renewed engagement including communication and infrastructure. The meeting at the general assembly is the first substantive bilateral engagement of the window: the foreign minister and the United States president's senior adviser for African affairs discussed renewed engagement including trade, investment, infrastructure, transportation, communication and security partnerships. It is a conversation rather than an instrument, and nothing has followed it on the base. No hyperscaler, cloud provider or technology company engagement of any kind is held for this country, from the United States or anywhere. The reason is structural as much as political: the external country assessment records the investment centre dormant and the investment law effectively suspended, so there is no route through which such an engagement would be constituted.	MOVEMENT
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	The standing instrument is a belt and road cooperation memorandum signed in November 2021. No digital or telecommunications project under it is named. The Chinese planning commission's own press release records the founding instrument: a memorandum on cooperation within the belt and road framework, signed on 24 November 2021 by the Chinese ambassador and the foreign minister. It has been reaffirmed at leader level since and remains the framework for the relationship. What the base cannot show is anything digital passing through it. No telecommunications, data-centre, network or equipment project under the framework is named for this country, and the state operator's network expansion is not attributed to any foreign partner. Nothing in the window records a new instrument, a project agreement or a disbursement.	NO CHANGE
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	European funding turned the research and documentation centre into a digital-preservation centre with training capacity, reported November 2025. The engagement that moved is a programme rather than an announcement. Successive European funding, with an Italian university as technical partner, has equipped the national research and documentation centre for digitisation, turning it into a digital-preservation centre with hands-on training capacity and linking to a draft national archives and libraries law. The same centre trained 64 local-institution employees in document management two months earlier, which is what that capacity is for. No bilateral digital-transformation memorandum exists. The instrument carrying European commitments is the partnership agreement signed in November 2023 and applied provisionally from January 2024, which lists the state among its parties and carries provisions on digital solutions for public access to information and on electronic governance.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments	One general cooperation agreement from October 2010, covering diverse sectors. No Gulf digital or telecommunications instrument was located. The principal Gulf-state relationship rests on a general cooperation agreement signed in October 2010 between the foreign minister and a Saudi minister of state, covering diverse sectors. It is the actual signed instrument that a meeting with a Saudi deputy foreign minister in February 2026 agreed to expedite the implementation of. Sixteen years on it has produced nothing digital that the base can see. No dedicated Gulf digital-transformation, telecommunications, data-governance or data-centre memorandum was located for this country, from any Gulf state, and no project under the 2010 agreement is named. What moved in the window was the diplomacy around the instrument rather than the instrument itself.	NO CHANGE
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	The standing instrument is the tele-education and tele-medicine network memorandum of November 2019, with an equipped learning centre on site. India's principal technology instrument with the country is the memorandum joining its tele-education and tele-medicine network project, signed on 7 November 2019, successor to an earlier pan-African network. It provides tele-education and tele-medicine over India-built portals with an on-site learning centre equipped with computers, an internet connection and audio-visual equipment. It remains the clearest signed dated technology instrument between the two, and nothing in the window adds to it: no disbursement, no extension, no successor and no enrolment figure. No India-Eritrea instrument on data governance, digital public infrastructure or payments was located, which is notable given how much of India's external technology engagement elsewhere takes that form.	NO CHANGE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National foundational digital ID	A named programme, pilot or vendor engagement for a foundational digital-ID system distinct from the passport/civil-registration base already on file.	not yet probed
Submarine fibre-optic cable landing	A licensing decision, application, or a dated update to the Submarine Networks registry's coastal-state count.	not yet probed
Starlink satellite internet service	A licence application, refusal, or an updated Starlink coverage-map entry for Eritrea.	not yet probed
Mobile money / digital payments service	A named mobile-money operator, licence or pilot, or a central-bank statement on digital payments distinct from the cash-deposit ultimatum.	not yet probed
Data-protection law	A published data-protection bill, statute or regulator designation.	not yet probed
Artificial intelligence law and strategy	A published national AI strategy or draft, or any statute or regulation addressed to artificial intelligence.	2026-08-31
Electronic transactions and e-commerce framework	A proclamation, regulation or gazetted bill giving legal effect to electronic signatures, records or contracts.	2026-08-31
Freedom of information law	An adopted freedom of information or access to information proclamation, with a request procedure and an appeal route.	2026-08-31
Statistics law	An enacted statistical proclamation giving the national statistics office a statutory mandate.	2026-08-31
Public discussion of government policy	An independent publication, permitted civil-society body or public forum in which digital or data policy is argued.	2026-08-31
National address and postcode system	A national postcode or street-addressing scheme, or a government statement that one is being built.	2026-08-31
Voter register	A voter register compiled under the electoral law, or an electoral commission constituted to prepare one.	2026-08-31

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Online government services	Any citizen-facing online government service — an application, payment, licence or record request completed online.	2026-08-31
Regional shared digital infrastructure	A signed interconnection, cable landing or regional infrastructure agreement naming Eritrea as a participant.	2026-08-31
Control of artificial-intelligence abuse	A domestic law, regulator, platform agreement or takedown route addressed to synthetic or manipulated media.	2026-08-31
National cybersecurity strategy	A published national cybersecurity strategy or the instrument adopting one, or a computer emergency response team's constitution or advisory record; a country profile states there is no public strategy, and the only incident on file is the government's own May 2024 announcement of an attack repelled, uncorroborated.	2025-01-01
National broadband strategy	An adopted national broadband policy, strategy or plan, or a later entry on the telecommunications union's own country table.	2026-12-01
Data localisation or residency rule	Any instrument stating where public or personal data may be held, or a hosting duty on public bodies.	2026-12-01
Open data policy or portal	An open data policy, a published dataset catalogue, or a licence under which government data is released.	2026-12-01
Internet exchange points	An exchange point appearing as active in the peering database or the exchange tracker, or a domestic peering arrangement.	2026-12-01
Justice sector management information system	Any named court case-management or justice information system, or a ministry statement describing one.	2026-12-01
Refugee and displaced-person protection framework	Accession to the refugee convention or the regional convention, or a national refugee or asylum statute.	2026-12-01
Position in the regional treaty and programme frameworks	Signature of the continental free trade agreement, or inclusion in the regional digital integration programme's coverage.	2026-12-01

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